

California to Idaho Relocation Guide

YOUR COMPLETE GUIDE TO THE TREASURE VALLEY

"Everything you need to know to make Idaho feel like home."



Faviola Zurita Pellerin

REALTOR® · RELOCATION SPECIALIST · SWEET GROUP REALTY

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Faviola Zurita Pellerin

REALTOR® · RELOCATION
SPECIALIST

Welcome to Your New Home — Idaho is Waiting

With 28+ years of experience in real estate and a deep understanding of what it means to relocate your family across state lines, I created this guide to give you an honest, comprehensive look at life in the Treasure Valley.

"I made this journey myself — and I can tell you firsthand that Idaho delivers on every promise."

Whether you're drawn by the affordability, the safety, the outdoor lifestyle, or simply the chance to stretch your dollar further, this guide will walk you through everything you need to know before, during, and after your move.

From the best neighborhoods for families to where to find authentic Mexican food, from the top school districts to the best hiking trails — I've got you covered. My goal is simple: to make your transition as smooth and exciting as it should be.

I'm fluent in both English and Spanish, and I specialize in helping California families navigate the Idaho real estate market. I look forward to being your guide.

22+

YRS IN REAL ESTATE

CA→ID

RELOCATION SPECIALIST

2

LANGUAGES SPOKEN

5★

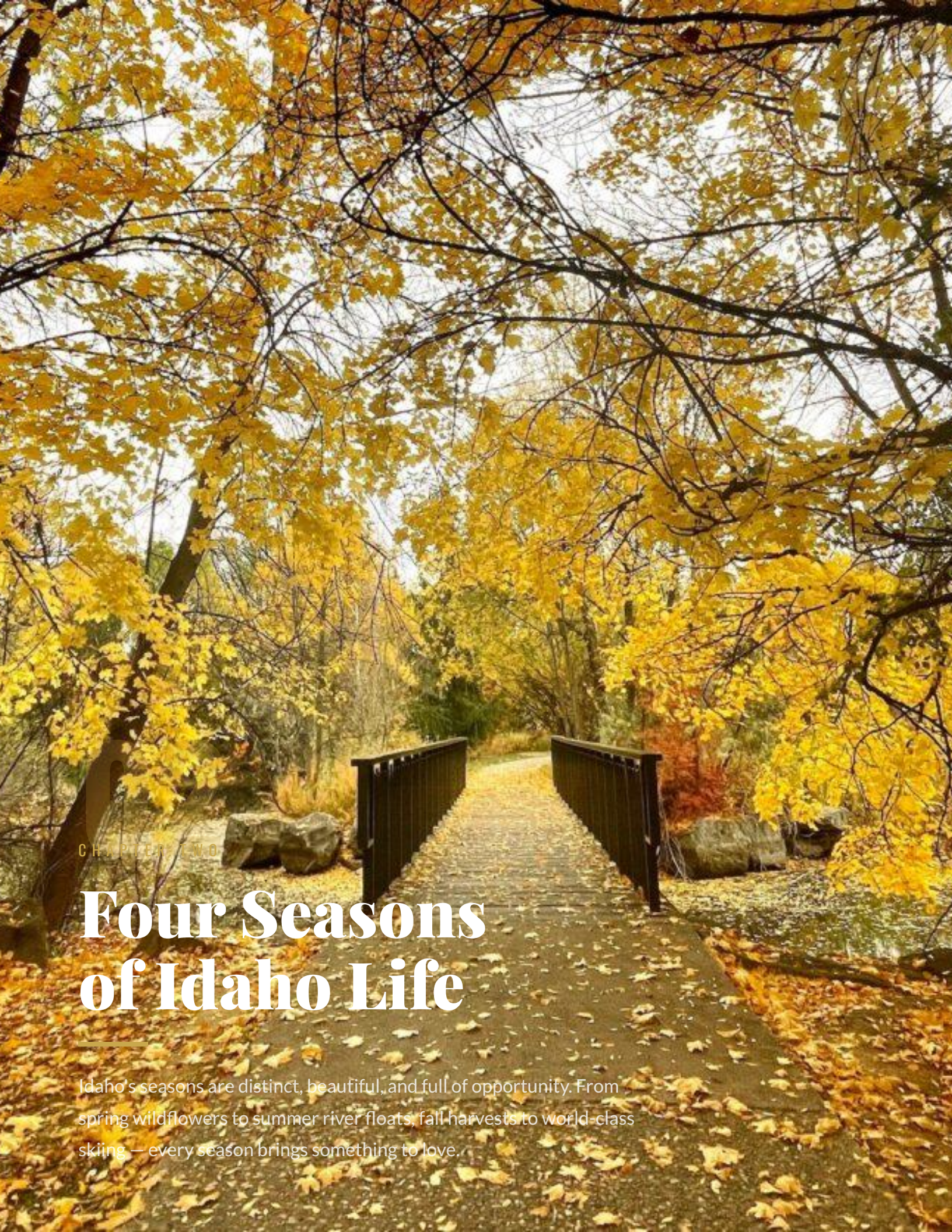
CLIENT SATISFACTION

READY TO START YOUR SEARCH?

Call or text Faviola today for a free, no-obligation buyer consultation.

(208) 830-7419

castilerealtygroup.com



CHAPTER TWO

Four Seasons of Idaho Life

Idaho's seasons are distinct, beautiful, and full of opportunity. From spring wildflowers to summer river floats, fall harvests to world-class skiing — every season brings something to love.

FOUR SEASONS

LIFE IN THE TREASURE VALLEY YEAR-ROUND





Dining in the Treasure Valley

Boise's food scene has exploded — farm-to-table pioneers, James Beard nominees, and authentic international cuisine.

FINE DINING

Chandlers Steakhouse

Boise's premier steakhouse. Dry-aged prime cuts, award-winning wine list, and impeccable service.

981 W Grove St, Boise

LATIN FINE DINING

Barbacoa

Latin-inspired fine dining with exceptional cocktails and creative seasonal cuisine in downtown Boise.

276 N 8th St, Boise

FARM-TO-TABLE

Bittercreek Alehouse

Farm-to-table pioneer. Local Idaho ingredients, craft beer, and a menu that changes with the seasons.

246 N 8th St, Boise

BREAKFAST

Goldy's Breakfast Bistro

Best breakfast in Boise. Lines out the door on weekends — worth every minute of the wait.

108 S Capitol Blvd, Boise

MEXICAN · FAVIOLA'S PICK

Cazadores

Authentic Mexican. Family-owned, incredible carnitas, and a warm atmosphere that feels like home.

Multiple Treasure Valley Locations

CRAFT BREWERY

Payette Brewing

Award-winning IPAs and a taproom right on the Boise Greenbelt. Idaho's most beloved craft brewery.

733 S Pioneer St, Boise

FAVIOLA'S NOTE

As someone who grew up in California, I was pleasantly surprised by the quality and variety of Boise's restaurant scene. The farm-to-table movement here is genuine — most restaurants source locally, and you can taste the difference. And yes, the Mexican food is excellent!

ARTS & MUSIC

Treefort Music Festival — 500+ artists, 5 days, March

Idaho Shakespeare Festival — Outdoor theater, June–Sept

Boise Philharmonic — Classical music, Oct–April

Boise Art Museum — Free first Thursday monthly

Boise Contemporary Theater — Year-round productions

SPORTS

Boise State Broncos — The blue turf. 36,000-seat stadium.

Idaho Steelheads Hockey — ECHL pro hockey downtown

Boise Hawks Baseball — Minor league, family-friendly

Western Idaho Fair — 200,000+ visitors, August

SHOPPING

Village at Meridian

Boise Towne Square Mall

BoDo District (downtown)

Hyde Park Boutiques

FAMILY FUN

Roaring Springs Water Park

Wahooz Family Fun Zone

Zoo Boise

Jump Time Trampoline Parks

DAY TRIPS

McCall (2 hrs)

Sun Valley (2.5 hrs)

Twin Falls / Shoshone Falls (2 hrs)

Craters of the Moon (2.5 hrs)



Outdoor Adventures

Idaho is an outdoor paradise. World-class hiking, skiing, fishing, rafting, and cycling — all within 30 minutes of home.



HIKING

Hulls Gulch Trail — 3.5 mi, Boise Foothills

Table Rock — 3.6 mi, iconic city views

Camel's Back Park — easy, family-friendly

Bogus Basin Trails — 30+ miles

Sawtooth NRA — world-class wilderness



WINTER SPORTS

Bogus Basin — 2,600 acres, 16 mi from Boise

Sun Valley — World-class, Bald Mtn 9,150 ft

Soldier Mountain — Hidden gem, uncrowded

Snowshoeing in the Foothills

Cross-country skiing at Bogus Basin



WATER ACTIVITIES

Float the Boise River — summer tradition

Lucky Peak Reservoir — boating & SUP

Payette River — whitewater rafting

South Fork Boise River — fly fishing

Cascade Lake — fishing & camping



CYCLING

Boise River Greenbelt — 25-mi paved path

Boise Foothills — 190+ mi singletrack

Ridge to Rivers Trail System

Hammer Flats — beginner-friendly

Bogus Basin road cycling

Idaho has been one of the fastest-growing states economically for the past decade. The Treasure Valley's job market is diverse, resilient, and expanding rapidly — attracting major employers from California, Texas, and beyond. The state's business-friendly tax environment and lower cost of living have made it a magnet for companies and talent alike.

EMPLOYER	INDUSTRY	EMPLOYEES
Micron Technology	Semiconductor / Technology	10,000+
St. Luke's Health System	Healthcare	15,000+
Saint Alphonsus	Healthcare	5,000+
Amazon	Logistics / Fulfillment	3,000+
Boise State University	Education	3,500+
HP Inc.	Technology	1,500+
Idaho Power	Utilities / Energy	2,000+
Clearwater Paper	Manufacturing	1,200+

5.8%

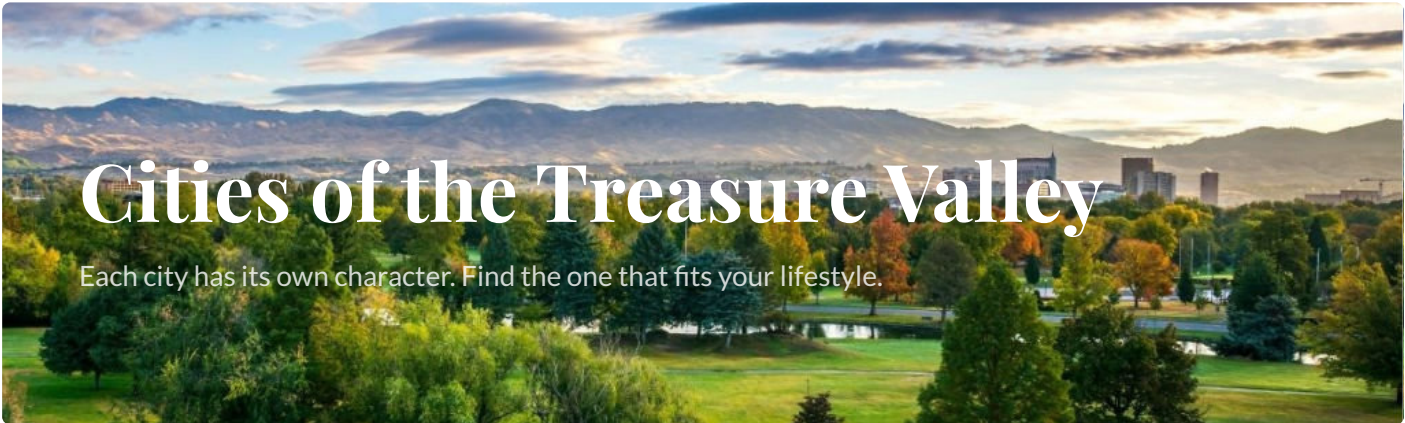
IDAHO INCOME TAX (FLAT)
vs. 9.3% California

0.63%

PROPERTY TAX RATE
vs. 1.1% California

99

COST OF LIVING INDEX
vs. 151 California



Cities of the Treasure Valley

Each city has its own character. Find the one that fits your lifestyle.

Boise

Pop. 240,000 • State Capital

\$425,000 median home

Idaho's capital and cultural hub. Thriving downtown, arts scene, and the iconic Boise River Greenbelt.

BEST FOR: URBAN LIFESTYLE, ARTS LOVERS

Meridian

Pop. 130,000 • Fastest Growing

\$415,000 median home

America's fastest-growing city. Excellent schools (West Ada), newer construction, Village at Meridian.

BEST FOR: FAMILIES WITH CHILDREN

Eagle

Pop. 30,000 • Upscale Suburb

\$550,000 median home

Boise's most affluent suburb. Quiet, safe, charming downtown, Eagle Island State Park.

BEST FOR: LUXURY BUYERS, QUIET LIFESTYLE

Nampa

Pop. 115,000 • Value Play

\$320,000 median home

Best value in the valley. Larger lots, newer homes at lower prices, growing retail scene.

BEST FOR: FIRST-TIME BUYERS, VALUE SEEKERS

Caldwell

Pop. 65,000 • Agricultural Heart

\$285,000 median home

Most affordable in the valley. Strong community, College of Idaho, famous Night Rodeo.

BEST FOR: BUDGET BUYERS, RURAL LIFESTYLE

Star

Pop. 15,000 • Hidden Gem

\$430,000 median home

Rapidly growing small town between Meridian and Caldwell. Newer subdivisions, tight-knit community.

BEST FOR: FAMILIES, NEWER CONSTRUCTION

TOP SCHOOL DISTRICT

West Ada School District

Idaho's largest and highest-rated district. Serves Meridian, Eagle, Star, and Kuna with 40+ schools, strong academics, competitive athletics, and robust extracurricular programs.

- ✓ Rocky Mountain High School
- ✓ Meridian High School
- ✓ Eagle High School
- ✓ Mountain View High School
- ✓ Centennial High School

SCHOOL DISTRICT

Boise School District

Strong arts programs, IB curriculum at Boise High, and a diverse student body. Serves the city of Boise with 50+ schools.

- ✓ Boise High School (IB Program)
- ✓ Timberline High School
- ✓ Capital High School
- ✓ Frank Church High School

PRIVATE SCHOOLS

Top Private Options

The Treasure Valley offers strong private school options for families seeking faith-based or alternative education models.

- ✓ Bishop Kelly High School (Catholic)
- ✓ Ambrose School (Christian Classical)
- ✓ Riverstone International (IB)
- ✓ Treasure Valley Classical Academy

HIGHER EDUCATION

Colleges & Universities

The Treasure Valley is home to several excellent colleges, led by Boise State University with 26,000 students and strong engineering and nursing programs.

- ✓ Boise State University (26,000 students)
- ✓ College of Idaho (Liberal Arts)
- ✓ Northwest Nazarene University
- ✓ College of Western Idaho (CWI)

Idaho's healthcare system has grown dramatically to meet the valley's rapid population growth. The Treasure Valley is home to two major health systems — St. Luke's and Saint Alphonsus — and dozens of specialty clinics, urgent care centers, and telehealth providers.

St. Luke's Health System

Idaho's largest health system. 8 hospitals across Idaho, with the flagship St. Luke's Boise Medical Center (342 beds) and the new St. Luke's Meridian Medical Center. Nationally recognized for cardiac care, cancer treatment, and orthopedics.

- + St. Luke's Boise Medical Center (342 beds)
- + St. Luke's Meridian Medical Center
- + Mountain States Tumor Institute
- + St. Luke's Children's Hospital
- + 50+ clinic locations valley-wide

Saint Alphonsus

Trinity Health system. 381-bed flagship hospital in Boise, plus Saint Alphonsus Nampa. Strong emergency care, heart center, and women's health services.

- + Saint Alphonsus Boise (381 beds)
- + Saint Alphonsus Nampa
- + Heart & Vascular Institute
- + Women's Health Center
- + Urgent care clinics valley-wide

HEALTH INSURANCE IN IDAHO

Idaho offers competitive health insurance rates compared to California. The state marketplace (**Your Health Idaho**) provides options for self-employed buyers and those between jobs during their move. Many California transplants are pleasantly surprised by the lower premiums and deductibles available in Idaho.

CALIFORNIA VS. IDAHO

THE NUMBERS THAT MATTER

CATEGORY	CALIFORNIA	IDAHO	YOUR SAVINGS
Median Home Price	\$786,000	\$415,000	~\$371,000
Property Tax Rate	1.1% / year	0.63% / year	43% less
State Income Tax	9.3% (top rate)	5.8% (flat)	Significant
Gas (per gallon)	\$4.80	\$3.20	\$1.60/gallon
Monthly Utilities	\$320 avg	\$185 avg	\$135/month
Car Insurance (annual)	\$2,190	\$1,240	\$950/year
Cost of Living Index	151	99	34% less

Solar Homes in Idaho — Powered by Pell Solar

Idaho is an excellent state for solar energy. With 206+ sunny days per year and favorable net metering policies, solar homeowners see strong returns. As a Pell Solar partner with 22 years of California solar experience, Faviola can connect you with trusted Idaho solar installers.

Net Metering

Idaho Power credits you for excess energy sent back to the grid — reducing your bill significantly.

Property Tax Exempt

Solar systems are fully exempt from Idaho property tax assessment — a major advantage over California.

30% Federal Tax Credit

The federal Investment Tax Credit (ITC) gives you 30% of your solar system cost back through 2032.

206+ Sunny Days

Idaho's sunny climate makes solar highly productive — often comparable to Southern California output.

YOUR MOVING CHECKLIST

FROM DECISION TO KEYS IN HAND

6 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Research Idaho neighborhoods and school districts
- ☐ Contact Faviola for a free buyer consultation
- ☐ Get pre-approved for an Idaho mortgage
- ☐ Research Idaho driver's license requirements
- ☐ Visit the Treasure Valley in person if possible
- ☐ Research Idaho vehicle registration process

1 MONTH BEFORE

- ☐ Finalize home purchase with Faviola
- ☐ Schedule moving company
- ☐ Set up Idaho Power & Intermountain Gas
- ☐ Update USPS address forwarding
- ☐ Update bank, insurance, subscriptions
- ☐ Arrange internet service (CenturyLink/Cox)

3 MONTHS BEFORE

- ☐ Begin active home search with Faviola
- ☐ Research moving companies (get 3 quotes)
- ☐ Notify California employer of relocation
- ☐ Research Idaho employers if needed
- ☐ Enroll children in Idaho schools
- ☐ Transfer medical records to Idaho providers

AFTER YOU ARRIVE

- ☐ Idaho driver's license (90 days to transfer)
- ☐ Idaho vehicle registration (90 days)
- ☐ Register to vote in Idaho
- ☐ Explore your new neighborhood!
- ☐ Get solar quote from Pell Solar
- ☐ Find a local doctor & dentist

QUESTIONS ABOUT THE MOVE?

Faviola has helped hundreds of California families make this exact move. Call her anytime.

(208) 830-7419

Se habla español

CASTILE REALTY GROUP

Ready to Make the Move to Idaho?

I'm here to guide you every step of the way — from your first home search to the day you get your keys.

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